

A stylized illustration of a protest scene. In the background, a person with blue hair and a megaphone is on the left, and a person in a red shirt with arms raised is at the top. On the right, a person in a white shirt and sunglasses is raising a fist. In the foreground, a person in an orange hoodie and sunglasses is also raising a fist. The background is a mix of beige, blue, and red geometric shapes.

SAID

Institute

Bowale, Manh, Ore, David, Christy, Jackie

Intro

The **SAiD Institute** is an arts and cultural organization dedicated to celebrating, preserving, and amplifying the rich heritage of the global African Diaspora. Through programs in art, education, community building, and and connection among people of African descent worldwide.

We are a team of students from the University of Houston Bauer College of Business partnering with **SAiD Institute** to develop a sustainable organizational structure and strategic plan.



PURPOSE

AND

GOAL

Project Overview

Goals

- Build a consistent and Reliable funding source
- Strengthen their partnerships and community engagement
- Develop a clear structure for their institution for long-term growth

Problems Identified

- Inconsistent funding
- Limited donor engagement
- Low online presence
- No clear sustainable structure for the year-long
- Need strong partnerships like libraries

Year-Long Sustainability Plan for SAiD Institute

TEAM MEMBERS & THEIR ROLES

- Bowale – Organizational Structure
- Manh – Grants & Fellowship
- Ore – Partnerships & Community Outreach
- David – Program & Events
- Christy – Digital Strategy
- Jackie – Funding Strategy & Donor Engagement



Org. Structure



Quarter 1 (Jan - Mar)

Kickoff Workshop, Application Cycle Time, Book Club Launch Event, Doing Outreach, Website Update, Newsletter

Quarter 2 (Apr - Jun)

Guest Speaker Series, Art Showcase, Donor Meetings, Grant Follow-ups, School Partnership (Spring Sem.), Virtual Events, Newsletter

Quarter 3 (Jul - Aug)

Institutional Partnership, Summer Events, More Workshops & Book Events, Grants and Donor Follow-up, Newsletter

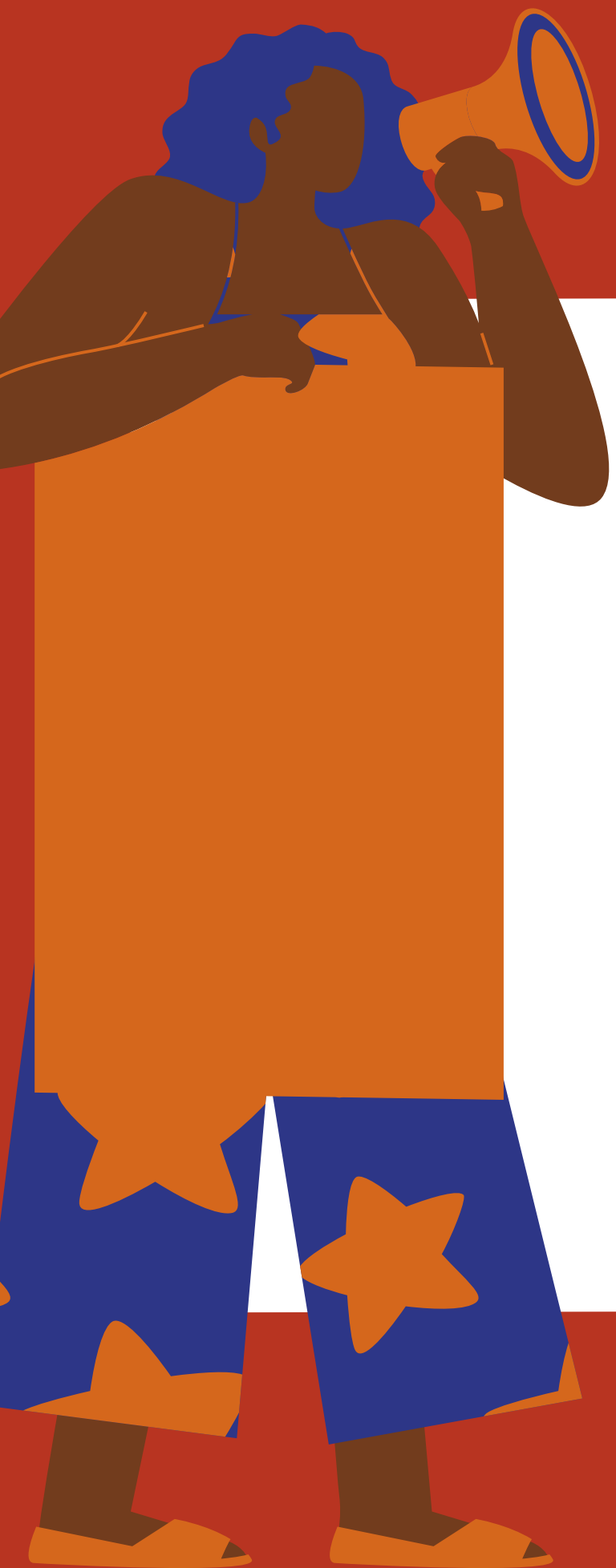
Quarter 4 (Oct - Dec)

School Partnership (Fall Sem.), End of the year Gala/Event, Annual report & Impact, Plans for next year, Workshop/showcase if needed, Newsletter

GOAL

- Corporate style sustainability with quarterly objectives
- Meeting ensures consistent funding from donors
- Newsletter ensures consistent communication

Grants & Fellowship



Grant Strategy

Core Challenge: current grant funding is unstable, inconsistent, and vulnerable.

What Hasn't Worked:

- SAID has been over-reliant on small, short-term grants from local sources (e.g., Houston Alliance, MAA).
- This model is high-effort, low-reward, and doesn't allow for long-term planning.

Solution: We must pivot from a reactive, project-based grant strategy to a proactive, institutional strategy. We need to secure grants that build long-term resilience.



An illustration of a person from behind, wearing a red long-sleeved shirt with the word 'SAID' in white capital letters. They are holding a large orange sign above their head with both arms. The sign has the text 'Key Grant & Fellowship Targets' in dark blue. The person is also wearing a white beanie with a red band.

Key Grant & Fellowship Targets

1: Major National Foundations

- Ford Foundation : Target their "Creativity and Free Expression" or "Gender, Racial, and Ethnic Justice" programs.
- Mellon Foundation: Target their "Arts and Culture" program.
- Strategy for these: We will approach them with the HMAAC partnership, framing it as a major, high-impact cultural initiative.

2: Humanities & Museum Grants

- National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH): "Public Humanities Projects" grant for joint exhibits or lecture series.
- Institute of Museum and Library Services (IMLS): "Museums for America" grant, which we can now co-apply for with the HMAAC.
- Humanities Texas: Public Program Grants (a strong local starting point).

Key Local Institutional Funders

- Houston Endowment: For general operating support, presenting ourselves as a key partner in Houston's cultural ecosystem.
- Texas Commission on the Arts (TCA): For "Arts Create" grants, which specifically fund operational costs.



Partnerships & Communities



SAID Institutions Goal



Goal- To develop long lasting relationships that support the SAID's Institutions missions and values.

Key Strategies:

- Develop mutually beneficial partnerships with schools, universities, libraries, and local art collectives.
- Collaborate with community leaders and cultural influencers to co-host events and expand visibility.
- Form corporate and nonprofit partnerships to secure sponsorships and joint programming opportunities.
- Create a "Community Partner of the Month" spotlight on social media to recognize collaborators and increase engagement.

Partnerships With High Schools

Collaborating with Houston's historically Black high schools, including Yates High School, will allow SAiD Institute to empower young students through mentorship, cultural education, and creative learning experiences.



Pop-Up's ^P

Promote SAiD Institute's mission, engage the community, and generate revenue to support educational and cultural programs.

Cultural Pop Ups -

- Afrobeats music, dance, and live performances to attract students and young adults.
- Art displays featuring African and African American artists.
- Collaborate with Black-owned vendors to create community market days.
- Feature traditional African foods or fusion snacks to attract attendees.
- These can be located anywhere from, Elementary Schools, Highschools, Universities, Carnivals, and local events.



Workshops and mini Events

- Quick cultural literacy workshops or entrepreneurship demos during the pop-up.
- Interactive storytelling, craft activities, or “Diaspora Dialogues” discussions.
- These can be set up at local Schools, University’s, Libraries, and Carnivals.

Merchandise

- Branded items such as T-shirts, tote bags, prints, and cultural toolkits.
- Limited-edition merchandise tied to special events or cultural celebrations.
- This will help advertise and bring revenue to the SAID institution



Program & Community Events

A stylized illustration featuring two white hands holding a large, cream-colored rectangular piece of paper. The paper is slightly tilted and has a torn edge on the right side. The hands are positioned at the bottom corners of the paper, with the fingers pointing upwards. The background is a solid red color. The title 'Program & Community Events' is written in a dark blue, serif font across the center of the paper. The overall style is clean and modern.

current digital landscape

STRENGTHS

- Website is visually appealing, informative, and includes event calendar
- Strong Instagram following (60.9K) with consistent event content

CHALLENGES

- Website lacks social media and donation integration
- Instagram has filler posts and can be too active
- No TikTok or digital merchandise presence



digital recommendations

Website Optimization

- Integrate social media feeds (Instagram and TikTok)
- Add donation and merchandise factors
- Feature book club and livestream events prominently

Social Media Growth

Instagram: focus on event videos, stories, and live sessions, refrain from posting memes

TikTok: create trend-based: use TikTok shop for merchandise and TikTok live

Merchandise & E-Commerce

Launch branded items (shirts, tote bags, mugs)

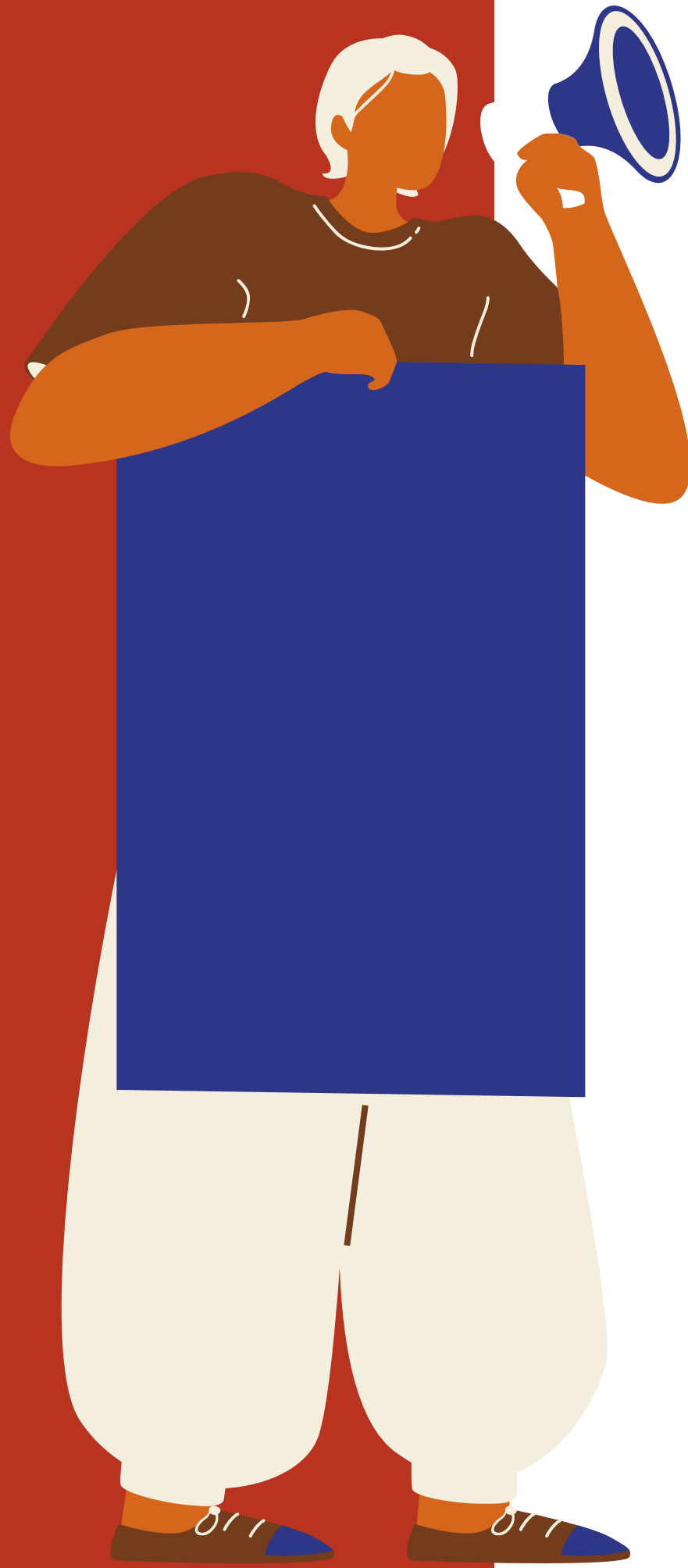
- sell through website and TikTok shop to fund programs



Next Steps

- 1. Integrate social media and donation features on website**
- 2. Launch TikTok & merch line**
- 3. Schedule first live stream event**
- 4. Track analytics monthly**



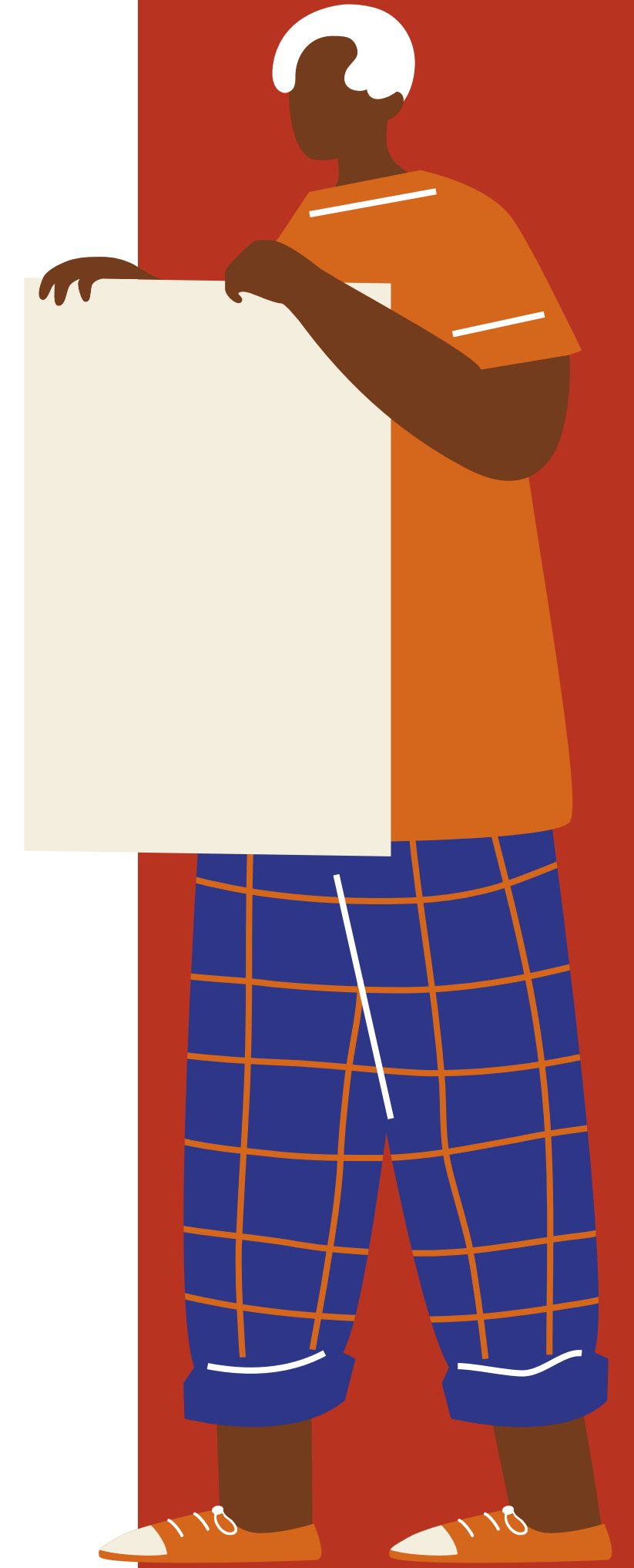


Donorship

Consistent donor engagement isn't simply about asking for money. It's about creating trust, recognition, and a shared purpose among your affiliates and donors.

The four pillars of donorship are: Awareness, Engagement, Commitment, and Advocacy.

Your goal should be to cultivate and build long-term, emotionally invested, and consistent donor relationships through community-driven engagement.

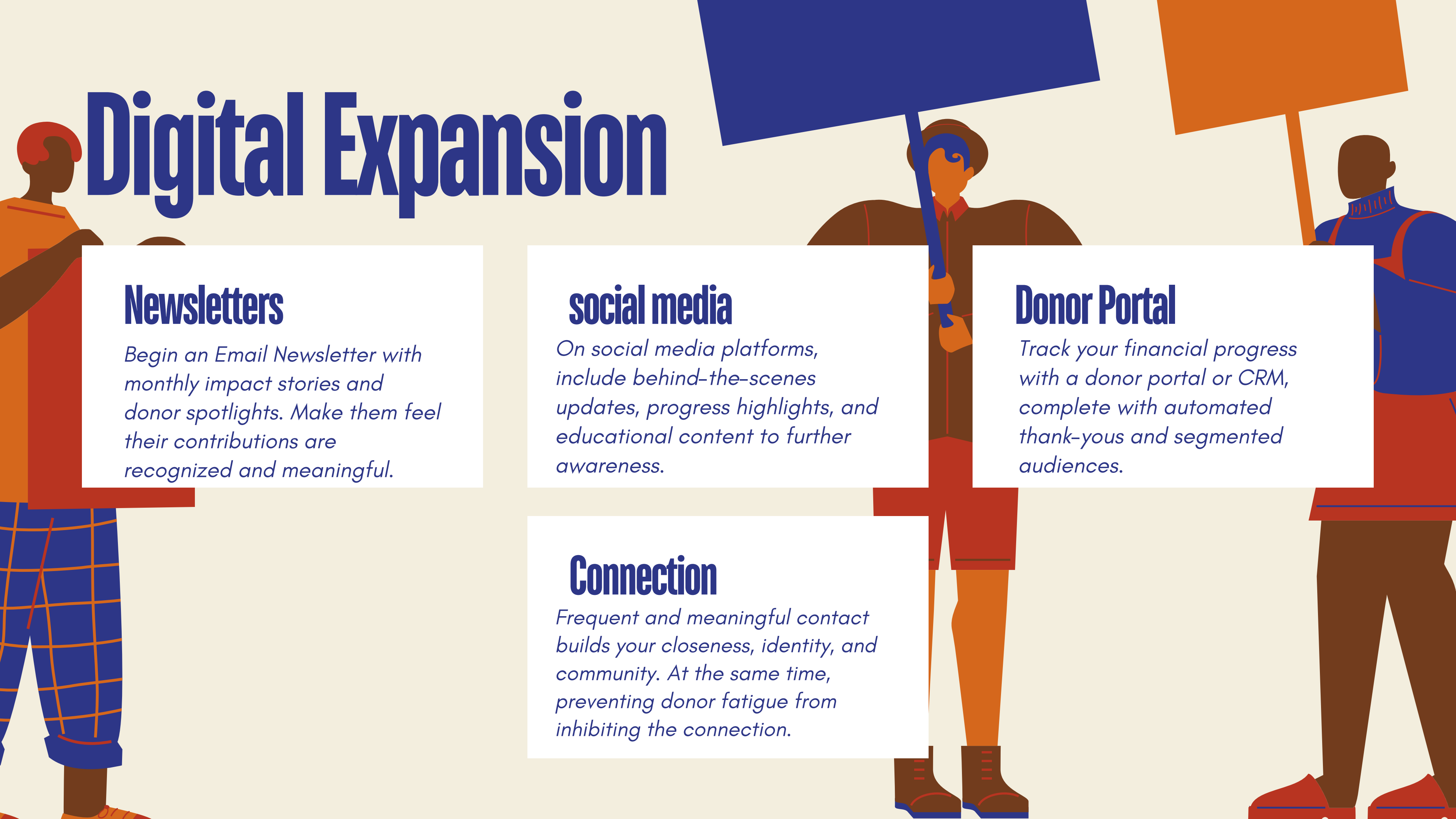


Partners in Impact

To begin building a relationship-based donor experience, you must treat your supporters as partners in impact. A partnership involves developing communication lines with your donor base, tailored to each donor's level of involvement.

- *Develop a tiered membership system that rewards members with exclusive content, discounts, and more.*
- *An institution that has achieved wild success with membership programming is the National Museum of African American History and Culture. They implemented exclusive perks for higher-ranking members, including early access to events, workshops, and recognition features*
- *Send updates to donors about the behind-the-scenes impact, let them know where their money is going, and how it supports your cause.*
- *. People are more willing to give when they feel part of a community or team rather than when it feels like a transaction. Giving will transform into belonging, inevitably increasing both loyalty and support from your donors.*



An illustration of three stylized figures holding large flags. On the left, a person with a red cap and orange shirt holds a blue flag. In the center, a person with a blue cap and brown shirt holds a blue flag. On the right, a person with a blue shirt and red skirt holds an orange flag. The background is a light beige color.

Digital Expansion

Newsletters

Begin an Email Newsletter with monthly impact stories and donor spotlights. Make them feel their contributions are recognized and meaningful.

social media

On social media platforms, include behind-the-scenes updates, progress highlights, and educational content to further awareness.

Donor Portal

Track your financial progress with a donor portal or CRM, complete with automated thank-yous and segmented audiences.

Connection

Frequent and meaningful contact builds your closeness, identity, and community. At the same time, preventing donor fatigue from inhibiting the connection.

Engagement Events

Finally, hosting regular engagement events (a combination of in-person and virtual) will boost excitement for donations and create touch points for progression.

- Begin Quarterly impact nights to celebrate successes and progress updates, while personally networking with your community.
- Bigger annual events, such as galas, help foster tradition and consistency with your audience.
- Hosting smaller donor appreciation events, like breakfasts or volunteer meetups, demonstrates your care for donors and fosters greater loyalty.



Timeline

Build structure, clarity, and storytelling base. (Months 1-3)

- Conduct a donor audit (who gives, how often, why).
- Segment your donor base: minor, mid-level, and major givers.
- Launch a branded donor communication plan (email + socials).
- Develop impact stories and branding materials for social media.

Deepen relationships and visibility. (Months 4-6)

- Launch a tiered membership or giving circle program.
- Introduce a quarterly Impact Update event or virtual town hall.
- Build out your CRM or donor management system.
- Collaborate with partners for a co-branded educational campaign.

Scale and emotionally connect. (Months 7-9)

- Scale and emotionally connect.
- Release donor impact video series or testimonials.
- Run a social campaign featuring your donors (“Why I Give”).
- Host a hybrid donor appreciation event.
- Pitch partnership stories to local media for visibility.

Retain, recognize, and optimize. (Months 8-10)

- Publish an annual impact report (digital and print).
- Send personalized year-end thank-you videos or cards.
- Announce next year’s goals and upcoming projects.
- Plan next year’s fundraising and engagement calendar.





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